

## **St Monica's Parish**

### **Diocese of Motherwell**

Registered Charity SC011041

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**Website:** <https://saint-monica.org.uk> **Facebook:** St Monica's Parish Coatbridge **Twitter:** @StMonicasParish

Parish Priest: Fr. Ghislain B. Mulumanzi.

**SUNDAY MASSES:** 10am

**WEEKDAY MASSES:** Mon – Sat 10am,

**CONFESSIONS:** on appointment.

**Holy Thursday:** Morning Prayer 10am, Last supper: 7pm and adoration thereafter.

**Good Friday,** Morning prayer 10am, Passion of the Lord 3pm.

**Holy Saturday:** Easter Vigil: 8pm

**Marriages:** Please speak to Fr Ghislain. Please note 6 months' notice is required.

**Hall Bookings:** No bookings are being taken as the hall is currently closed

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### **Palm Sunday of the Passion of the Lord. Year A**

Procession: Mt21: 1-11

1<sup>st</sup> Reading: Is 50:4-7

2<sup>nd</sup> Reading: Phil 2:6-11

Gospel: Mt26:14-27:66

### **Readings for next Sunday: Easter Sunday. Year A**

1<sup>st</sup> Reading: Acts 10:34,37-43

2<sup>nd</sup> Reading: Colossians 3:1-4

Gospel: Jn 20:1-9

### **Children's Liturgy**

The diocesan Education Team has prepared children's liturgy material for Palm Sunday and it can be accessed at [https://youtu.be/sxctmIMl\\_V4](https://youtu.be/sxctmIMl_V4). The Diocesan Retreats Officer, has also provided Lenten prayers and guided meditation for children on <https://youtu.be/lcyV9UNgbUs>.

### **A Home Liturgy for Palm Sunday 2020**

*If you have a garden and can get some greenery, then get enough to give a piece to each person in isolation with you. If you cannot cut some greenery but have a potted plant, place that on the table – it will remind you and anyone with you of the strange year we are in. Sit down around the table you are normally at for meals. If you do not have such a common table, then sit around where you normally eat.*

Sisters and brothers, this Sunday we gather as individual households or alone in our homes. In all instances God is with us, the Christ is among us, and the Church is at prayer. This prayer resource is for you this Sunday.

### **Opening**

Have a piece of greenery in your hand

*Leader or together:*

Sisters and Brothers, we have observed the 40 days of Lent. We unite ourselves to the Church Universal and pray that we may enter this Holiest of Weeks with reverence and hope. We pray: God of all creation, these branches recall for us the joy of that day when Jesus, fulfilling the scriptures, made his entry into Jerusalem. Bless this greenery we hold in our hands that it may go with us throughout the coming year.

*All:*

Blessed is the King who comes in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest.

### **Gospel: Matthew 21:1-11.**

**Reader:** A reading from the holy Gospel according to Matthew. Jesus and the disciples drew near Jerusalem. When they came to Bethphage on the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two disciples, saying to them, "Go into the village opposite you, and immediately you will find an ass tethered, and a colt with her.

Untie them and bring them here to me. And if anyone should say anything to you, reply, 'The master has need of them.' Then he will send them at once." This happened so that what had been spoken through the prophet might be

fulfilled: Say to daughter Zion, "Behold, your king comes to you, meek and riding on an ass, and on a colt, the foal of a beast of burden." The disciples went and did as Jesus had ordered them. They brought the ass and the colt and laid their cloaks over them, and he sat upon them. The very large crowd spread their cloaks on the road, while others cut branches from the trees and scattered them on the road. The crowds going ahead of him and those following kept crying out and saying: "Hosanna to the Son of David; blessed is the he who comes in the name of the Lord; hosanna in the highest." And when he entered Jerusalem the whole city was shaken and asked, "Who is this?" And the crowds replied, "This is Jesus the prophet, from Nazareth in Galilee."

### **The Gospel of the Lord.**

**All:** Praise to you, Lord Jesus Christ.

### *Then together say:*

O Gates lift high your heads; Grow higher ancient doors. Let him enter the King of Glory! Who is the King of Glory? He, the Lord of Host, he is the King of Glory.

*Spend a minute in silence thinking about the Gospel. Then talk together about what Jesus will do in Jerusalem in the coming days. What will happen on Holy Thursday, Good Friday and Easter Sunday? Remind one another that Jesus is present in this domestic liturgy: 'for where two or three have gathered in my name, there am I in the midst of them' (Mt 18:20).*

### **Prayer of the Faithful**

Leader: Let us pray.

#### *Let each in turn lead an intercession:*

- We pray for all those infected by the Coronavirus around the world, for those who care for them, for health specialists and authorities who are combatting the spread of infection, and for all who at this time are feeling anxious.

**Lord hear us**

Response: Lord graciously hear us

- For all believers: that we take up the cross each day and remain faithful to the Lord.

**Lord hear us.**

Response: Lord graciously hear us

- For world leaders: that they may govern with mercy, justice and respect for the rights of all people for just treatment, food, water, shelter and safety.

**Lord hear us.**

Response: Lord graciously hear us

- For wealthy nations and people; that they act with compassion and concern for the poor and marginalised.

**Lord hear us.**

Response: Lord graciously hear us

- Make your own prayers for those who are sick or in need. Ask God to protect them.

*Finish each prayer with: — Lord hear us.*

### *Then the leader says:*

We pray for those who have died that they may rest in the loving presence of the Lord. **Lord hear us.**

And now let us pray together as Jesus taught us:

### *Everyone prays this together*

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

For the kingdom, the power, and the glory are yours, now and for ever. Amen.

**Leader:** May God bless us and keep us safe.

### **Please remember in your prayers:**

**Sick:** Jacky Whelan, Maddy Kelly, Helen Watson, Jean Graham, Anne Doyle, Linda Slevin, Stephen Kelly, Alice Deas, Patricia McGhee, Marie Taylor, John Black, Peter Silvestro, Joe Cope, Margaret McAuley, Peter & Hugh Alexander & Macey McColl, John Tighe & Patsy Loney

**Recently dead:** Mary Toal, Ian Ferrie, John Black, Beryl Cairns, Tess McMahon & William O'Connor

**Months Mind:** Elizabeth & Sadie Prunty, Jimmy McLaughlin; Tilly & Marie Clarke, Kathleen & Peter Dolan.

**Anniversaries:** James Prunty & May McLaughlin.

### **Please also remember the souls who have no one to pray for them**

**All:** In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

### **Coronavirus – Volunteering**

The Covid-19 crisis has left many people isolated and vulnerable. The elderly, the infirm and the unemployed are just a few of the groups experiencing considerable difficulties at the present time.

Thankfully there are many kind-hearted souls out there who are willing to give of their time to help those in need. A great number of people have engaged in voluntary work in recent weeks and some have created 'pop-up' community resilience groups, adding to the work already done by established groups such as the Society of St Vincent de Paul.

However, in providing this valuable support, volunteers must remain cognizant of Government guidelines on social distancing and hygiene. **Ready Scotland** is the official Scottish Government resource providing information on how to safely and responsibly volunteer to help others during the Coronavirus crisis.

The information, below, is taken directly from **Ready Scotland** and should prove to be a useful resource for anyone wanting to volunteer at this time and for those who would like to set up a community resilience group.

### **Only help if you are well**

Follow advice on [nhsinform.scot/coronavirus](https://nhsinform.scot/coronavirus) to ensure it is safe for you to help.

### **People who may be in need of help**

You can help: Neighbours, friends or family who have to stay at home because someone in the household has coronavirus/symptoms.

Neighbours, friends or family who are 70 and over, or have and health conditions (that means you are offered the flu jab on grounds of health each year)

### **Providing practical help**

There are simple ways you can help your neighbours without exposing yourself or them, if they cannot leave the house:

You could do some food shopping for them when you are doing your own.

You could place an online shopping order for them or talk them through the process over the phone.

You could pick up their prescriptions or arrange a pharmacy delivery where available.

You could support with general errands such as posting letters or putting the bins out.

If you are helping with prescriptions, you should remind people that they must only order the medication they need in their usual quantities; nobody should be stockpiling.

### **How to do this safely**

Try to limit the amount of time you spend outside of your home by picking up essential items for others only when you do your regular shop.

You should not physically visit people who are self-isolating as this would put you at risk of infection, or risk spreading it to others. This means you shouldn't enter their house or go on a car journey with them.

Keep a distance of at least 2 metres (3 steps) away from people you are helping – if you have to see them on the doorstep

Leave any shopping or other messages on the doorstep, but make sure that they have been collected before leaving.

Remember to wash your hands regularly with soap and warm water for at least 20 seconds.

Do not place yourself in compromising positions where you may feel unsafe, for instance helping late at night. Be aware that if you are helping someone you don't know personally, they may not want to share personal details with you like phone numbers. You should also warn those you are helping not to let strangers into their home – and not to give strangers money under any circumstances.

### **Providing emotional support**

Self-isolation can be a really lonely time. However, Government advice is available to protect the most vulnerable in our society. We can help each other by staying in touch – whether neighbours or friends and family who live further away. You can do all of these from your own home:

You personally can help with regular calls, text messages and contact via social media.

You can also help by talking people through the setup for video calls so they can connect with their friends and family remotely.

You can encourage people to stay mentally and physically active with activities such as cooking, reading, gardening, online learning or watching films.

Swap suggestions about how to keep busy. If people are well enough; encourage them to do some light exercise and keep active around the home, perhaps by using an online exercise class.

Share trusted sources of information. It's easy to become worried by online information, some of which may be deliberately designed to mislead people. Help your community by sharing trusted information from websites like:

**NHS Inform, Scottish Government, Mind, our list of services** providing additional support

### **What should I do if I'm worried about someone's health?**

If the health of anyone you are in touch with or supporting is a cause for concern, encourage them to call their GP practice or NHS24 on 111 if the GP is closed.

Similarly, if they cannot cope with their symptoms at home, their condition gets worse or their symptoms do not get better after 7 days, please call NHS24 on 111.

**Call 999 immediately if you believe someone's life is at risk.** You can also click to find out more about [where you or they can find additional support](#).

### **What should I do if I have to stay at home and need help?**

Please refer to guidance on staying at home. If someone you don't know calls at your home, always ask for valid ID and always ensure you are comfortable sharing details like your phone number or address. Only provide information on a need-to-know basis and if you have seen valid ID. Do not share financial details like credit/debit card numbers.

Do not feel pressured into providing information. If you have doubts about those who are approaching you, and are concerned, it is advised that you don't engage, and report serious suspicious behaviour to police.

Remember that genuine volunteers have been instructed not to enter your home and should all have documentation proving their status.

### **Community Resilience Groups**

There are a large number of local community groups that have already started to rally local support. Look out for these on Facebook and in local community channels, and join in. If you would like to set up a new community resilience group, we have guidance available. These groups provide great help not only during the current challenges, but also in future during bad weather or other disruption.